



Education and Childcare

Ministry Business Plan

Education and Childcare

Business Plan 2026-29

Ministry Fact Sheet – Mandate and Structure

The Ministry of Education and Childcare provides leadership, direction and oversight for an accessible, affordable and high-quality childcare system and to enable the delivery of a student-centred education system that prepares students for lifelong success.

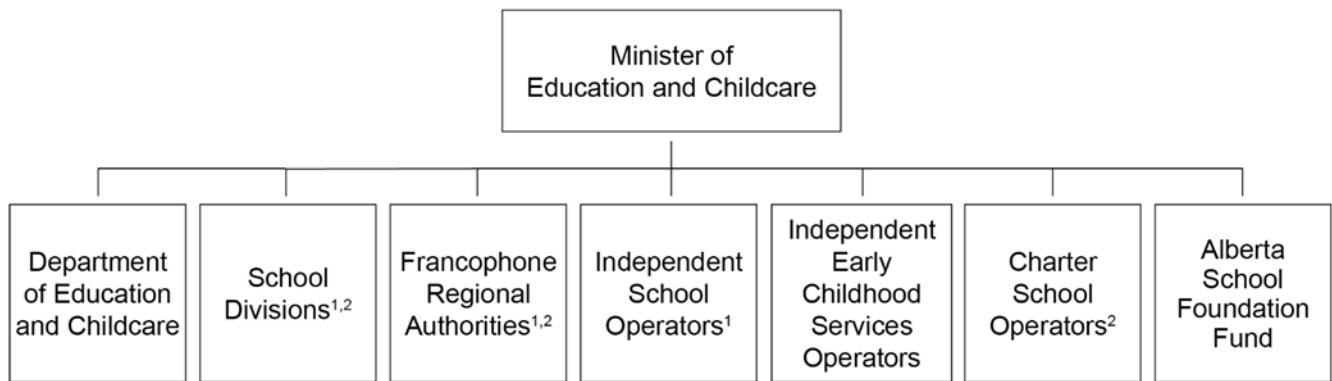
Education and Childcare is responsible for a provincial Kindergarten to Grade 12 (K-12) curriculum that provides the foundation for all learners to achieve provincial student learning outcomes and succeed in developing the knowledge, skills and competencies needed to pursue their career pathways and make meaningful contributions to their communities and the world. The ministry supports a range of education options to promote choice within the education system, including public, separate, francophone, charter and independent schools as well as alternative programs, early childhood services and home education programs.

Education and Childcare is implementing targeted actions to address class size and classroom complexity. These actions include creating new and renovated student spaces across the province to keep pace with Alberta's growing student population, supporting the hiring of new teachers and educational assistants and providing school authorities with access to specialized learning supports. The Class Size and Complexity Cabinet Committee will use data collected from the education system to allocate strategic investments to address classroom complexity. Mandatory literacy and numeracy screenings will strengthen early identification of foundational learning needs and enable evidence-informed planning for interventions.

Education and Childcare collaborates with Canadian and international jurisdictions and organizations to share research and best practices that keep Alberta students competitive on the global stage. The ministry collaborates with education and ministry partners to support Alberta's diverse students. The department works to ensure eligible students have access to francophone education while encouraging opportunities for French education through French language programs. The department also supports the education system to improve outcomes for First Nations, Métis and Inuit students, incorporating Indigenous histories, cultures, languages and perspectives in curriculum and promoting foundational knowledge for teachers and school leaders.

Education and Childcare is committed to achieving a sustainable childcare system that benefits Alberta families and supports childcare providers. The ministry works to increase access to childcare by supporting childcare providers in offering high quality, accessible, affordable and inclusive childcare through licensing, funding and monitoring childcare programs to ensure the safety and well-being of children.

The Ministry of Education and Childcare consists of:



¹Includes supervision of home education programs

²Denotes a part of the public education system

The Ministry of Education and Childcare remains committed to regulatory approaches and program delivery that reduce unnecessary government oversight and emphasizes outcomes, in order to improve access to government services, attract investment, support innovation and competitiveness, and grow Alberta businesses.

A more detailed description of Education and Childcare and its programs and initiatives can be found at: alberta.ca/education-and-childcare.

Ministry business plans should be considered in conjunction with all budget documents - including the Fiscal Plan, Government Strategic Plan, and Estimates - which work together to provide a complete overview of government's commitment to responsible fiscal management.

2026-29 Business Plan

Outcome 1

Alberta's students are successful

The ministry supports the success of Alberta's students through a strong Kindergarten to Grade 12 education system that provides opportunities for students to build the foundations for successful and fulfilling lives.

Key Objectives

- 1.1 Provide curriculum that focuses on literacy, numeracy, financial literacy, citizenship and practical life skills.
- 1.2 Collaborate with other ministries to expand mental health and well-being supports for students.
- 1.3 Develop and maintain comprehensive provincial assessments, including mandatory literacy and numeracy screenings, that assess progress, identify learning gaps and monitor student success.

Initiatives Supporting Key Objectives

- A total allocation of \$10.8 billion in operating expense in 2026-27 to support instruction and early childhood services programs in school authorities.
- A total of \$1.84 billion is allocated in 2026-27 for learning support funding to attend to unique and diverse learning needs of children and students, including supporting student mental health and well-being in schools.

Performance Metrics

1.a Performance Measure: High school completion rate (2024-25 data available June 2026)

High school completion is important for entry into the labour force and post-secondary programs. In 2023-24, 87.1 per cent of students completed high school within five years of entering Grade 10.

Targets	2026-27	87.3%	2027-28	87.7%	2028-29	88.0%
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1.b Performance Measure: Percentage of students who achieved the acceptable standard on Grade 9 provincial achievement tests

Demonstrates the effectiveness of the education system in preparing students for high school. In 2024-25, 69.7 per cent of students achieved the acceptable standard on Grade 9 provincial achievement tests in language arts and 51.7 per cent achieved the acceptable standard in math.

Targets	2026-27	Language Arts: 70.2% Math: 52.0%	2027-28	Language Arts: 70.4% Math: 52.5%	2028-29	Language Arts: 70.6% Math: 53.0%
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1.c Performance Measure: Percentage of students who achieved the acceptable standard on diploma examinations

Student results on diploma examinations are a solid measure of whether high school students are achieving high standards. In 2024-25, 85.7 per cent of students achieved the acceptable standard on diploma examinations in language arts and 76.0 per cent achieved the acceptable standard in math.

Targets	2026-27	Language Arts: 86.0% Math: 77.0%	2027-28	Language Arts: 86.5% Math: 78.0%	2028-29	Language Arts: 87.0% Math: 79.0%
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Outcome 2

First Nations, Métis and Inuit students in Alberta are successful

Alberta Education and Childcare collaborates with education partners and provides supports to improve First Nations, Métis and Inuit student education outcomes.

Key Objectives

- 2.1 Strengthen education programs, policies and initiatives for First Nations, Métis and Inuit students’ success.
- 2.2 Increase understanding of approaches to First Nations, Métis and Inuit student achievement and promote effective practices in Indigenous Education.
- 2.3 Enhance relationship-building with First Nations, Métis and Inuit communities, partners and schools to enhance student success and advance reconciliation.

Initiatives Supporting Key Objectives

- A total of \$4.6 million is allocated in 2026-27 to address the unique learning needs of First Nations students, including specialized learning supports and both universal and targeted mental health supports and services.

Performance Metrics

2.a Performance Measure: High school completion rate of self-identified First Nations, Métis and Inuit students (2024-25 data available June 2026)

High school completion is important for entry into the labour force and post-secondary programs. In 2023-24, 69.7 per cent of self-identified First Nations, Métis and Inuit students completed high school within five years of entering Grade 10.

Targets	2026-27	70.0%	2027-28	70.3%	2028-29	70.5%
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Outcome 3

Alberta’s students have access to a variety of learning opportunities to enhance competitiveness in the modern economy

The ministry provides innovative learning opportunities to ensure a variety of career pathways for students to enter post-secondary education or their chosen fields in the workforce.

Key Objectives

- 3.1 Enhance career education programming opportunities that enable grades 7 to 12 students to explore various occupations.
- 3.2 Collaborate with other ministries, education and industry partners to improve student preparedness in transitioning from high school into a variety of careers including high demand trades and post-secondary training.
- 3.3 Support collegiate school opportunities to create more pathways for students to post-secondary education and the workforce.

Initiatives Supporting Key Objectives

- \$6.6 million is allocated to school authorities to provide sustainable, predictable career education funding.
- \$32.1 million is allocated to collegiate schools, in support of increased access to career education programming.

Performance Metrics

3.a Performance Measure: Satisfaction with career education opportunities

Effective career planning enables students to enter the labour force or post-secondary programs. In 2024-25, 71.5 per cent of students, parents, teachers and school board members were satisfied that students receive the necessary supports to plan for a career or life after school.

Targets	2026-27	72.0%	2027-28	72.5%	2028-29	73.0%
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3.b Performance Indicator: Average number of career education credits completed per high school student

Tracking average credits completed in career education provides insight on how high school students are taking advantage of career education opportunities. Results are based on student population data.

	2020-21	2021-22	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25
Average career education credits completed per student	6.5	7.1	7.3	7.3	7.3

Outcome 4

Alberta’s K-12 education system and workforce are well-managed

Alberta Education and Childcare supports the professional growth and development of teachers, school leaders, school authority leaders and educational assistants. The department directs the education system and oversees the administration of education programs and services through legislation, provision of funds and planning suitable learning facilities.

Key Objectives

- 4.1 Implement school capital strategies to renovate and increase the number of student spaces in the communities of greatest need.
- 4.2 Establish a data-driven approach to monitor and allocate resources towards mitigating the impact of class size and classroom complexity on students and teachers.
- 4.3 Develop and implement abbreviated teacher certification pathways for qualified individuals with degrees, diplomas or trade credentials in high-demand fields to teach in Alberta’s K-12 classrooms.
- 4.4 Continue to create operational and financial efficiencies within the education system by identifying options that improve consistency and streamline processes and procedures.
- 4.5 Promote choice in education to enhance student learning through a variety of schooling options.

Initiatives Supporting Key Objectives

- \$4.1 billion in capital investment is allocated over three years to maintain, enhance, plan and build new schools.
- \$355 million is allocated in 2026-27 to address classroom complexity.

Performance Metrics

4.a Performance Measure: Agreement that schools are able to attract and retain teachers

Attracting and retaining excellent teachers enables high learning outcomes and greater student achievement. In 2024-25, 70.3 per cent of principals agreed that they are able to attract and retain teachers in their schools.

Targets	2026-27	71.0%	2027-28	71.5%	2028-29	72.0%
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4.b. Performance Measure: Satisfaction that school provides a safe, caring and healthy learning environment

A safe, caring and healthy learning environment is fundamental to facilitating student learning. In 2024-25, 83.6 per cent of students, parents, teachers and school board members were satisfied that schools provided a safe, caring and healthy learning environment.

Targets	2026-27	83.8%	2027-28	83.9%	2028-29	84.0%
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4.c. Performance Measure: Agreement that students can access supports and services in a timely manner

Timely access to supports and services fosters effective learning. In 2024-25, 72.9 per cent of students, parents, teachers and school board members agreed that there was timely access to student supports and services.

Targets	2026-27	73.3%	2027-28	74.5%	2028-29	74.7%
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Outcome 5

Alberta families have access to high quality, inclusive, and affordable childcare options

The ministry is committed to providing a high quality, affordable and sustainable childcare system to meet the needs of Alberta families.

Key Objectives

- 5.1 Support access to affordable, high-quality and inclusive licensed childcare by negotiating a financially sustainable federal childcare agreement.
- 5.2 Enhance quality licensed childcare through workforce investments that strengthen the recruitment and retention of skilled early childhood educators in the childcare system.
- 5.3 Improve access to affordable out of school care programs for families, through income-tested family supports.

Initiatives Supporting Key Objectives

- In 2026-27, the ministry will allocate \$1.77 billion for affordable, high-quality and inclusive licensed childcare.
- In 2026-27, the ministry will allocate \$344 million to support the recruitment and retention of early childhood educators working in licenced childcare facilities.

Performance Metrics

5.a Performance Measure: Percentage change in the number of licensed childcare spaces

This includes daycare, family day home, out-of-school care, preschool and innovative and group family child care programs. Childcare programs safely operate while leveraging federal investments for focused space creation, if applicable. In 2024-25, there was a 10 per cent increase in the number of licensed and active child care spaces.

Targets	2026-27	9%	2027-28	3%	2028-29	3%
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STATEMENT OF OPERATIONS

(thousands of dollars)

(thousands of dollars)	Comparable				
	2025-26 Budget	2025-26 Forecast	2026-27 Estimate	2027-28 Target	2028-29 Target
REVENUE					
Education Property Tax	3,124,000	3,124,000	3,591,700	3,792,394	3,848,405
Early Learning Child Care Agreements	1,146,598	1,197,307	1,170,088	1,121,024	1,121,024
Transfers from Government of Canada	148,787	123,555	122,511	113,187	111,681
Other Federal Transfers	100	25,400	17,550	100	100
Premiums, Fees and Licences	237,225	243,494	249,727	254,892	260,416
Investment Income	49,719	48,787	49,756	50,894	52,007
Internal Government Transfers	322,088	322,088	322,088	322,088	322,088
Fundraising, Gifts and Donations	87,074	82,635	82,635	82,635	82,635
Other Revenue	207,617	186,908	191,362	195,211	199,232
Ministry Total	5,323,208	5,354,174	5,797,417	5,932,425	5,997,588
Inter-Ministry Consolidations	(322,088)	(322,088)	(322,088)	(322,088)	(322,088)
Consolidated Total	5,001,120	5,032,086	5,475,329	5,610,337	5,675,500
EXPENSE					
Ministry Support Services	6,726	7,315	8,109	8,109	8,109
Instruction - ECS to Grade 12	7,664,229	7,505,329	8,392,040	8,924,690	9,053,990
Operations and Maintenance	806,151	846,151	843,451	874,951	877,551
Student Transportation	533,525	499,725	505,025	503,925	509,125
Accredited Independent Schools and Early Childhood Service Operators	461,107	461,607	530,807	552,607	584,307
School Facilities	522,602	593,299	641,398	541,902	531,716
Governance and System Administration	284,800	299,800	303,900	309,600	313,500
Program Support Services	119,492	202,892	201,778	201,745	201,722
Labour Disruption Payments	-	204,000	-	-	-
Child Care	1,961,791	1,922,785	2,128,270	1,470,155	1,466,395
Debt Servicing Costs	56,629	56,629	48,993	52,501	55,635
Ministry Total	12,417,052	12,599,532	13,603,771	13,440,185	13,602,050
Inter-Ministry Consolidations	(18,499)	(86,760)	(127,519)	(27,618)	(11,999)
Consolidated Total	12,398,553	12,512,772	13,476,252	13,412,567	13,590,051
Net Operating Result	(7,397,433)	(7,480,686)	(8,000,923)	(7,802,230)	(7,914,551)
CAPITAL INVESTMENT					
School Facilities	1,030,858	1,081,286	1,579,857	1,386,049	900,987
Program Support Services	565	757	565	565	565
Labour Disruption Payments	-	1,000	-	-	-
Child Care	5,000	18,670	15,000	-	-
Consolidated Total	1,036,423	1,101,713	1,595,422	1,386,614	901,552

